

18

DECRIMINALISE TO CATALYSE

► The Jan Vishwas Act 1.0 amended 42 laws, converting several provisions with jail terms to penalties. It eliminated 183 criminal provisions. A Jan Vishwas Bill 2.0 has been envisaged to decriminalise more offences and improve ease of doing business. But the government needs to spread a wider net to ensure that things such as missed compliances and procedural errors do not lead to jail sentences and criminal cases.

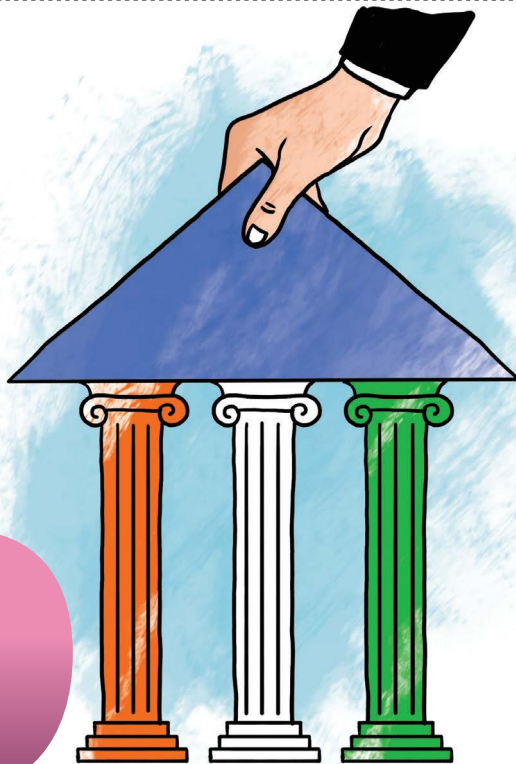


24 |

19

BUILD BIGGER, MORE EFFICIENT BANKS

► India's banking system does not reflect its economic prowess. Only State Bank of India and HDFC Bank feature among the top 100 global lenders. A strategic push is needed to ensure operational scale and global reach. Reforms for consolidation and more licences and freedom to bring in more capital could give India a bank of global scale and further the cause of financial inclusion.



20

IMPROVE CONSUMER & INVESTOR PROTECTION

► From digital arrests over the phone to mis-selling of financial products by banks and insurance agents to meet targets, Indian consumers and investors are bearing the brunt of all kinds of malfeasance. As financial transactions move away from traditional banking channels and retail investors flock to markets for higher returns, stronger regulatory action is needed to prevent mis-selling and protect investors and consumers. Instead of relying on hotlines and ombudsmen to report frauds, levying hefty fines and using advanced tech to catch fraudsters could be the way ahead.